

My Claude Usage Strategy

Personalized model & effort-level workflow — Student profile (Coding, Resume Building, Career Prep)

Recommended Primary Model

Claude Sonnet 5

Why This Model Fits Me

You're coding daily and want fast, reliable answers — Sonnet 5 is Anthropic's best all-round balance of speed and coding strength, without the extra cost or latency of Opus. For a student doing debugging, homework help, resume drafts, and interview prep, it covers roughly 90% of tasks well.

When to Use Haiku 4.5

- Quick syntax lookups (e.g. Python list comprehension syntax)
- Fast rewrites of a resume bullet or email
- Simple Q&A where you just need a fast, correct answer
- High-volume, low-complexity daily use

When to Use Sonnet 5

- Writing/debugging real code (scripts, projects, assignments)
- Resume and cover letter drafting/polishing
- Mock interview prep, behavioral question practice
- Most day-to-day coding help — this should be your default

When to Use Opus 4.8

- Complex, multi-file coding problems or architecture decisions
- High-stakes documents (final resume before applying, dream-job cover letter)
- Career strategy (e.g. planning a path from student to SWE at a top company)
- When Sonnet's answer feels shallow or you need deeper reasoning

Recommended Effort Level

Level	When to Use It
Low	Quick facts, syntax checks, one-line fixes.
Standard	Everyday coding help, resume tweaks, explaining concepts — your default mode most days.
High	Debugging tricky bugs, resume for a specific job application, interview answer refinement. Ask Claude to ‘
Max	Big decisions: project architecture choices, full resume overhaul, career-path planning. Ask for extended r

My Personalized Claude Workflow

Task	Best Model	Best Effort	Reason
Quick code syntax/error lookup	Haiku 4.5	Low	Fast, cheap, sufficient
Daily coding/debugging	Sonnet 5	Standard	Strong reasoning, fast enough
Complex coding project	Opus 4.8	High	Needs deeper multi-step logic
Resume first draft	Sonnet 5	Standard	Good writing quality, quick
Final resume for specific job	Opus 4.8	High / Max	High-stakes, worth the depth
Mock interview practice	Sonnet 5	Standard	Natural conversation, fast
Career path planning	Opus 4.8	Max	Complex, long-term reasoning
Simple Q&A / fact check	Haiku 4.5	Low	Speed over depth

Biggest Mistakes I Should Avoid

- Using Opus for everything — wastes time/cost on simple tasks Haiku handles fine
- Using Haiku for your actual job-application resume — too important to skimp
- Not telling Claude to “think step by step” on hard coding bugs — you'll get a shallower answer
- Treating every resume/interview task the same — job-application-ready output deserves more rigor than a rough draft

Final Recommendation

If I could use only **ONE** model and **ONE** effort level for most of my work:

Claude Sonnet 5 at Standard effort.

It handles daily coding, resume work, and career prep well without overkill. Bump to Opus (High/Max effort) only for the handful of high-stakes moments — your final resume, a tough architecture decision, or a big career plan. That combo covers about 90% of your needs efficiently and saves the “power mode” for when it actually matters.